

Phishing Analysis Fundamentals

Introduction

Social engineering involves several attacks, where Phishing and Spam are the common attacks. Phishing attacks may be in form of Phone calls, text messages or emails. For an organization with a well built layered defense strategy, it only takes an inexperienced and unsuspecting user within your corporate environment to click on a link or download and run a malicious attachment which may provide an attacker a foothold into the network.

Level 1: The email address

This level provided a brief history on the invention of email which was done by a man called **Ray Tomlinson**. I was also able to understand the features that make up an email address.

Answer the questions below

Email dates back to what time frame?

1970s

✓ Correct Answer

Level 2: Email delivery

This level provided knowledge on protocols involved to facilitate email messages. Different protocols include, **SMTP, POP3, IMAP**.

Answer the questions below

What port is classified as Secure Transport for SMTP?

465

✓ Correct Answer

What port is classified as Secure Transport for IMAP?

993

✓ Correct Answer

What port is classified as Secure Transport for POP3?

995

✓ Correct Answer

Level 3: Email Headers

Learnt how email travels from point A to point B and all the protocols involved in the process. Also covered what makes up an email message when it arrives in an inbox.

Answer the questions below

What email header is the same as "Reply-to"?

Return-Path

✓ Correct Answer

Once you find the email sender's IP address, where can you retrieve more information about the IP?

http://www.arin.net

✓ Correct Answer

Level 4: Email Body

part of the email which contains the text (plain or HTML formatted) the sender wants you to view

Answer the questions below

In the above screenshots, what is the URI of the blocked image?

https://i.imgur.com/LSWotDI.png

✓ Correct Answer

In the above screenshots, what is the name of the PDF attachment?

Payment-updateid.pdf

✓ Correct Answer

In the attached virtual machine, view the information in email2.txt and reconstruct the PDF using the base64 data. What is the text within the PDF?

THM{BENIGN_PDF_ATTACHMENT}

✓ Correct Answer

💡 Hint

Level 5: Types of Phishing

At this level, I was to understand the different types of malicious emails which include; **Spam, Phishing, Spear phishing, Whaling, Smishing, Vishing.**

What trusted entity is this email masquerading as?

Home Depot

✓ Correct Answer

What is the sender's email?

support@teckbe.com

✓ Correct Answer

What is the subject line?

Order Placed : Your Order ID OD2321657089291 Placed Successfully

✓ Correct Answer

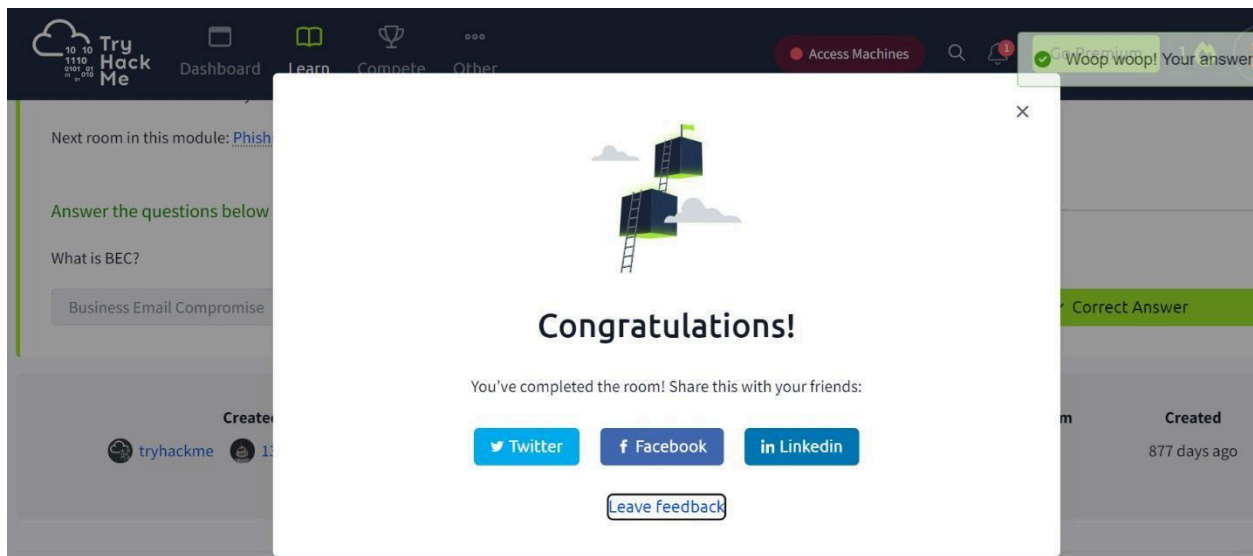
What is the URL link for -CLICK HERE? (Enter the defanged URL)

hxxp[;///t[.]teckbe[.]com/p/?j3=EOowFcEwFHI6EOAyFcoUFV=TVEchwFHIUFOo6lVTTDcATE7oUE7AUET==

✓ Correct Answer

💡 Hint

Module completion



<https://tryhackme.com/r/room/phishingemails1tryoe>

Conclusion

In conclusion, the module covered Phishing in details which is an example of social engineering attack. The module also provided a detailed overview on how to detect and mitigate the phishing emails. I was also able to understand **BEC (Business Email Compromise)** when an adversary gains control of an internal employee's account and then uses the compromised email account to convince other internal employees to perform unauthorized or fraudulent actions.